

Ancient Indian History - Practice Set 03

RRB NTPC 2026 - History Syllabus Practice Series
Comprehensive Mixed Chapters Mock Test (10 Questions)

Question 1 — Topic: Prehistoric Period

The Upper Paleolithic site of Patne in Maharashtra is highly celebrated in Indian archaeology for yielding which specific material evidence?

- A) Engraved ostrich eggshell fragments (Correct)
- B) Polished jade celts
- C) Terracotta mother goddess figurines
- D) Copper double-edged axes

Explanation: Patne yielded engraved fragments of ostrich eggshells, showing early cognitive expression and resource tracking in Upper Paleolithic India.

Question 2 — Topic: Indus Valley Civilization

Analysis of the mature Harappan chert cubical weights demonstrates which distinct metrological system layout?

- A) Purely sexagesimal tracking matching contemporary Sumeria
- B) A binary sequence for lower units, shifting to decimal/hexadecenal scaling for higher units (Correct)
- C) Erratically varying scales showing localized tribal standards
- D) A completely decimal progression exclusively used for grains

Explanation: Harappan weights show an orderly binary sequence for small values (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32...) transitioning to a base-16 decimal system for heavy items.

Question 3 — Topic: Vedic Period

Which Vedanga discipline is specifically focused on the etymology and structural derivation of obscure words?

- A) Shiksha
- B) Nirukta (Correct)
- C) Kalpa
- D) Chhandas

Explanation: Nirukta, authored famously by Yaska, is the auxiliary Vedic study focused strictly on etymology and semantic derivations.

Question 4 — Topic: Religious Movements

The fundamental schism leading to the emergence of the Sthaviravada and Mahasamghika lineages occurred during which council?

- A) First Council at Rajagriha
- B) Second Council at Vaishali (Correct)
- C) Third Council at Pataliputra
- D) Fourth Council at Kashmir

Explanation: The Second Buddhist Council at Vaishali saw the initial major ideological and disciplinary schism over Vinaya practice updates.

Question 5 — Topic: Mahajanapadas

In the Mahaparinibbana Sutta, the Buddha details the 'Aparihaniya Dhamma' to secure the political stability of which republican confederacy?

- A) Mallas of Kusinara
- B) Vajjikas of Vaishali (Correct)
- C) Shakyas of Kapilavastu
- D) Koliyas of Devadaha

Explanation: The Buddha gave these advice directives to the Vajjian/Licchavi league to maintain internal cohesion against Magadha's aggressive expansion plans.

Question 6 — Topic: Mauryan Empire

Which Major Rock Edict of Ashoka explicitly records his profound remorse following the Kalinga War and mentions contemporary Hellenistic rulers?

- A) Major Rock Edict VI
- B) Major Rock Edict IX
- C) Major Rock Edict XIII (Correct)
- D) Major Rock Edict II

Explanation: Major Rock Edict XIII provides a detailed look at the Kalinga conquest toll, Ashoka's transition to Dhamma, and named Greek contemporary kings.

Question 7 — Topic: Post-Mauryan Period

The silver coin hoard of Jogalthembho contains thousands of coins belonging to which Western Kshatrappa king counter-struck by the Satavahanas?

- A) Chastana
- B) Rudradaman I
- C) Nahapana (Correct)
- D) Bhartridaman

Explanation: Gautamiputra Satakarni overstruck the silver currencies of Nahapana, celebrating his victory over the Kshaharata house.

Question 8 — Topic: Gupta Empire

In the administrative structure of the classical Gupta state, who were the Kumaramatyas?

- A) High-ranking elite civil administrative cadres serving as provincial or district officials (Correct)
- B) Direct commanders of cavalry divisions
- C) Low-level village accounting bookkeepers
- D) Royal coin mint superintendents

Explanation: Kumaramatyas formed a premier class of administrative executives closely linked to the royal lineage or aristocracy.

Question 9 — Topic: South Indian Dynasties

The earliest copper plate grants of the Pallava dynasty (such as Mayidavolu and Hirahhadagalli) are unique because they were composed in which language?

- A) Pure Classical Tamil
- B) Sanskrit exclusively
- C) Prakrit using early Brahmi script (Correct)
- D) Old Kannada

Explanation: Early Pallava records used Prakrit, reflecting continuity with early Satavahana style administrative frameworks prior to switching to Sanskrit and Tamil.

Question 10 — Topic: Sangam Age

Which prominent port city located on the southwestern Malabar coast served as the primary Indo-Roman exchange mart for black pepper during the Sangam era?

- A) Arikamedu
- B) Puhar
- C) Muziris (Correct)
- D) Korkai

Explanation: Muziris was a famous trading hub on the western coast of south India that handled high-volume trade with the Roman Empire.